



Delaware County Council Meeting April 28th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NZOr24QbK2Q
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Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the County Council was called to order on April 28th by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Scott (Council President)
 - **Members Present:** Ron, Larry, Jessica, Ryan, Jane, and other council members (as indicated via roll call votes).
 - **Members Absent:** Paul (explicitly noted as absent during discussion).

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with remote/virtual call-in procedures due to ongoing pandemic conditions.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to approve prior meeting details/agenda was made, seconded, and approved.

Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:22 Auditor's Financial & Revenue Report**
 - **Presenter:** Donna (County Auditor)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Donna presented financial reports highlighting significant revenue shortfalls anticipated due to unemployment impacts, drops in highway revenue, LIT/EDIT taxes, and an \$800,000 flat agreement with the city regarding EMS that leaves a \$200,000<U+2013>\$320,000 deficit against anticipated revenues. Additionally, a temporary tax anticipation loan/draw may be required to keep County General out of the red until May 20th. Total revenue reductions/losses discussed approach \$1.6 million.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote recorded at this specific timestamp.
- **00:07:33 [20–20] Resolution Regarding Part-Time Employee Hours & Force Reductions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill (Attorney) / Council Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding reducing/furloughing part-time employees except for essential maintenance, and addressing concerns that some part-time staff were paid while staying at home. Lengthy debate occurred regarding the inclusion of specific roles (like the mailroom clerk) and whether to restrict part-time hours to 15 or 20 hours per week rather than 29 hours, ensuring part-time staff only get paid for hours actually worked while the building remains restricted.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as Amended by Roll Call Vote (reducing part-time hours cap to 20 hours/week and excluding full layoffs pending further review).
- **00:40:58 EDIT Appropriations (3 Million Dollar Request)**
 - **Presenter:** Donna (Auditor) / Board Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a large \$3 million appropriation request for Economic Development Income Tax (EDIT) funds to cover bond obligations (such as bridge projects) and operational expenses through the remainder of the year. Council members noted the large sum, but staff clarified these are existing legal obligations and bond payments that must be met despite overall revenue declines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:50:15 Additional Appropriations: Office Machines**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department Representative / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$3,800 for office machines (Line RC-441).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:46:46 Grant Appropriations (Various Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Staff / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of grant funds including childhood/homeschool visitor grants (Funds 101, 102, 103), family recovery court case management (Fund

104), and fighting back grants. Brief clarification sought regarding whether item 104 constituted a salary increase.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:52:38 Health Department / Enforcement Fund Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Health Department / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for professional services (\$30,000) under Cornerstone / Health Environmental Enforcement Fund (recording fees, enforcement, education totaling \$7,519.07).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:54:28 Highway Contractual Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$775,896 for contractual services (match funds).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:55:59 Commissioners Transfer / Position Creation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer requests and a request to create a new full-time position (VA assistant / line items a-137). Council members noted this conflicts with the newly passed resolution restricting hiring and position creation during budget shortfalls.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Failed by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous "No").
- **00:58:37 Drain Board Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Drain Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$1,500 for board member compensation. Council noted these are state-statute appointed board members rather than standard county employees.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **01:03:09 Communications (911) & Public Safety Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Department / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriations for public safety/communications. Council noted that public safety positions (jailers, deputies, dispatchers/communications techs) were explicitly excluded from general hiring/hours freezes as essential functions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **01:06:50 PPE and Mask Reimbursement Discussion / Approvals**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers (EOC / Emergency Management) / Prosecutor's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding sourcing and funding personal protective equipment (PPE), specifically 10,000 procedure masks for court systems, jurors, witnesses, and staff. Jason Rogers updated the council on FEMA public assistance grants, Department of Justice COVID response grants (\$58,000), and Medicaid/EMS stimulus funds (\$108,000) designated for PPE and virus control.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jason Rogers (Emergency Management Director) provided detailed updates on grant applications and FEMA reimbursement expectations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote to cover necessary COVID-19 safety equipment and associated financial transfers/salary ordinance amendments.
 - **01:15:36 Authorization for Electronic Signatures**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to allow electronic signatures on documents approved during the meeting so officials do not have to travel to the county building individually during pandemic restrictions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
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Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:36:53 Public Comment Check:** Council President Scott noted for the record that he refreshed the email system and **no public comment emails** had been received. (No live public speakers addressed the floor during this period).
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Extensive closing remarks by council members expressing mutual appreciation for teamwork during the COVID-19 pandemic response, coordination with the EOC, and managing severe upcoming budgetary constraints.
 - Lengthy discussion and frustration expressed regarding the state-legislated Sixth District Court mandate coming down without allocated funding, compounding local fiscal stress alongside EMS, 911, and revenue downturns. Plans discussed to review Justice Center build-out plans in light of fiscal reality.
- **Adjournment:**
 - Motion made and seconded to **Recess** (rather than fully adjourn) to allow the council to quickly reconvene for emergency situations as pandemic rules evolve.

- **Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote; meeting recessed.

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